

RAI@CHI: Responsible and Human Centred AI Across Borders

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Abstract

As AI deployment accelerates globally, the urgency for responsible AI(RAI) frameworks has catalysed unprecedented policy initiatives and research investments worldwide. The CHI community, positioned uniquely at the intersection of technology, people, society, and values, has a crucial role in shaping RAI development. This meet-up brings together international HCI researchers working across value-sensitive design, human-centered AI, ethics, explainability, trustworthy AI, sustainability and equitability to foster collaborative dialogue on CHI's perspectives and potential in RAI. Through an interactive town hall format featuring community standups, democratic topic selection, and structured roundtable discussions, we will generate actionable outcomes including network building, knowledge sharing, and concrete collaboration opportunities for the CHI community around RAI. This meetup would serve as a foundational response from the CHI community to establish priorities, forge connections, and catalyse the next generation of RAI research that centers human values, promotes fairness, and advances democratic principles in an era of AI transformation.

Keywords

Responsible AI, Artificial Intelligence

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1 Introduction

As AI is gaining footholds in business applications and everyday life, there is a dire need for responsible design and development. We view Responsible AI as an active effort to “design, evaluate, regulate, and operate AI-systems in ways that benefit people, society and the nation.” [6]. This ranges from ethics, trustworthiness and embodied values to the social and environmental sustainability, fairness and inclusivity and representativeness.

The urgency of this need for regulation is reflected internationally on a policy level: be it the EU AI Act [7], the 2023 U.S. Executive Order on AI [8] or the UN Report on Governing AI for Humanity [5]. These regulatory frameworks represent a coordinated global response to AI governance challenges, with the EU alone committing over € 2.6 billion through Horizon Europe, an additional € 1 billion annually through the Digital Europe Programme specifically for AI research and development.

This policy momentum is paralleled by substantial research investments worldwide. The U.S. National Science Foundation announced \$140 million in 2023 to establish 7 new AI research institutes, bringing the total to 25 nationwide, focusing on trustworthy and ethical AI research. The EU's GenAI4EU initiative has committed nearly € 700 million across Horizon Europe, the Digital Europe Programme, and the European Innovation Council to integrate generative AI responsibly across strategic sectors. Canada launched the Canadian Artificial Intelligence Safety Institute (CAISI) with \$27 million in funding as part of a broader \$2.4 billion AI investment, leveraging its world-leading AI research ecosystem through institutions like Mila, Amii, and the Vector Institute. In the U.K. UKRI has funded several key initiatives championing various aspects of responsibility in AI including the £33m Responsible AI UK

and the £15.9 BRAID. Additionally, the U.S. government announced \$15 million in foreign assistance funding to build global capacity for responsible AI governance, while private foundations like the Gates Foundation have awarded nearly 50 grants to researchers in low- and middle-income countries developing AI solutions.

2 HCI's Strategic Position and Opportunity

As this focus on responsibility seeps across layers of the society from policy to funders to research, we as the HCI community, positioned at the intersection of technology, people, society, culture and values, have a grand stake in designing a future that embodies and champions responsible AI. Embedded in a challenging global political atmosphere where equality has been de-emphasised, the question of how can CHI, as a community of international interdisciplinary socio-technical researchers make RAI possible stands unexplored. We propose this Meet-Up as a curtain raiser response from the CHI community to this challenge to bring together a sub-community in CHI who are interested in this domain, to foster discussion on CHI's perspectives, potential and interests in responsible AI and to serve as a networking opportunity that would build the foundation for the next generation of responsible AI research.

The CHI community's relevance to this challenge is evidenced by the dramatic growth in AI-focused research within HCI. CHI 2024 featured extensive AI-related work [9], including workshops on "Generative AI and HCI" [2], "Human-Centered Explainable AI" [1], and the SIG "Human-Centered Responsible Artificial Intelligence: Current & Future Trends" [3], alongside numerous papers addressing AI ethics, transparency, and human-AI collaboration. Notable examples include work such as "Farsight," [4] a tool for developers using large language models that alerts them to potentially harmful prompts, which earned an honorable mention for CHI 2024's best paper award.

3 An International Community Meet-Up

The meet-up would be of relevance to all HCI researchers engaged in AI work, from data collection to model training to application to those exploring the socio-technical aspects of AI, an interest stream which has been gaining much traction in the recent years (seen from the increase in number of papers submitted and accepted at CHI that involves AI). With such rise in momentum in this landscape within the CHI community, it is critical that future HCI adapts to this phenomenon to be relevant and concurrent. HCI has traditionally showcased its capacity to reinvent itself to adapt to changing times. The call for the same, but maybe on a scale unprecedented is posed by AI and the rapid changes this implicates. We propose an interactive town hall at CHI 2026, featuring 45-minute community standups, sli.do voting to select discussion topics, and structured roundtables led by programme committee members (Appendix A.2).

Hence we bring together a global panel of HCI experts, from diverse nations, ethnicities, professional experience and research expertise within the organising team. This builds a strong starting point that is representative of the multidimensional diversity that both AI and the CHI community holds. Split between the organising and programme committees, these personnel would be active participants within the meet-up and leverage their extensive

networks spread across the globe to maximise attendance at the meet-up. We present the organising committee details herewith:

Neelima Sailaja is an Assistant Professor in Computer Science at the University of Nottingham. She leads the U.K.-India "Off-Grid AI Solutions" project, co-designing AI with farmers in India. Her digital sustainability work spans the U.K. and South-East Asia, earning her membership in the U.K. Government Digital Sustainability Alliance Working Committee on AI and Sustainability. She has organized international workshops at CHI, NordiCHI, DIS, and TVX.

Simone Stumpf is a Professor of Responsible and Interactive AI at the University of Glasgow. Her research focuses on Explainable AI, human-centered machine learning, and fairness assessments. She has served on organizing committees for workshops at IUI and CHI, held senior roles at CHI, IUI, and EICS conferences, and organized CHI SIGs on RAI in 2023 and 2024.

Rishub Jain is a Research Engineer at Google DeepMind. For the past 2 years, he has been working on improving Human-AI collaboration, specifically to prevent reward hacking in LLMs - the field of Amplified Oversight. His work focuses on combining Humans' and AI's Complementary strengths, to make LLMs more aligned to human values.

Heloisa Candelero is a Senior Research Scientist at IBM Research Brazil, specializing in Conversational User Interfaces and Responsible AI. Her work explores the design and evaluation of ethical, engaging AI interactions, with contributions published in top HCI venues and patented innovations in conversational systems.

Neha Kumar is an Associate Professor at Georgia Tech's School of Interactive Computing. Her research focuses on responsible and sustainable human-centered computing, investigating infrastructures of care. Through community-engaged research, she foregrounds worker-centered perspectives and community wellbeing in care contexts.

Min Kyung Lee is an Assistant Professor and Director of the Human-AI Interaction Lab at UT Austin. Her research examines algorithms' social implications in management and governance. She has received nine best paper awards at CHI and CSCW, and serves on the FAccT steering committee.

Raquel Iniesta is a Reader in Statistical Learning for Precision Medicine and leads the Fair Machine Learning Lab at the Department of Biostatistics & Health Informatics. Raquel is dedicated to developing and championing ethical, human-centred AI in health-care.

Joel Fischer is Professor of HCI at the School of Computer Science, University of Nottingham, UK. His research in Human-AI Interaction takes a human-centred view to understand adoption and embedding of AI-infused technologies into everyday life and work to benefit societies. He is currently Co-Investigator and Research Pillar Lead on Responsible AI UK, a national programme in the UK to coordinate the ecosystem on Responsible AI research in the UK.

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